



Comments received by Verra during the public comment period 15 APR 2024 – 15 MAY 2024 of ARAGUAIA REDD+ BOCALON PROJECT, ID #5044

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Comment 1

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Sent by:

Organization:

Country:

The criteria for choosing the methodology are appropriate since it is a REDD+ project considering unplanned deforestation (AUD). In the topic of additionality, in Regulatory Surplus, it is said that the project activity is not mandatory by law, however the Brazilian Forest Code determines that the Legal Reserve area be conserved. Furthermore, additionality can be challenged, as the project proponent is an agribusiness company and is part of the Toyota group. The property has an area of 35% designated as a legal reserve in accordance with legislation, and even if deforestation pressure in the region is high, why would the project proponent need income from the VCU to carry out the project? The part of analyzing investments in additionality needs further elaboration.

In the baseline scenario, the forest is expected to be converted into non-forest by deforestation agents operating in the reference region, the project area and the leakage belt. The baseline is coherent, but the calculations are confusing and in disagreement with the Standard's formatting rules, as well as the estimation tables. The estimate is 8,058 tCO₂e/year for 60 years (on 10,012 hectares) and is not an overestimate, but it is difficult to make an accurate analysis due to the confusing calculations.

The PDD does not comply with the requirements of Verra's template. Through the index it is possible to analyze that the PDD has additional sections, altered from the original template, making the calculations confusing and going against the Standard rules. The estimation tables are also not up to standard. Up to page 73, template 4.3 is used and from page 74, template 4.2 is used.



A public consultation was carried out with beneficiaries and the process is clear and complete. As there is no population living in the project area, the PDD describes the FPIC as being the contract between the project proponent and the property owner.

The company is committed to allocating 5% of its own returns, generated from the sale of credits, to finance and implement impactful social initiatives in communities around the project area. Those interested and directly impacted by the project activities are within the boundaries of the property, being the landowner and the workers of the Tapirapé farm. Around the area, there are some interested parties directly or indirectly affected, such as indigenous populations and residents of the municipality of Santa Terezinha. The Urubu Branco community, for example, is adjacent to the project area, and therefore any positive impacts will automatically extend to that area, as will the allocation of social development revenues from the project - the same applies to local residents of the County. The risks were listed and mitigation measures were listed.